5: Manage Charts

Practice Instructio

How to use this guide: Download and open your **Excel_E5_Starter** file. Work through each skill using the instructions below. Each skill shows what to do and what the result looks like. Check off each skill on the IS101 reference page.

Skills in This Guide

1. Create a Chart
2. Create a Chart Sheet
3. Modify Chart Type and Data
4. Format Chart Elements
5. Add and Modify Chart Elements
6. Apply Chart Layouts and Styles
7. Add Alt Text to Chart

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1 Create a Chart

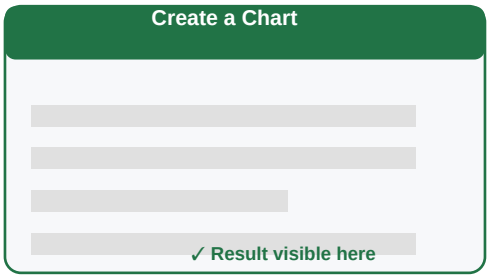
Insert →

Your Task: Create a Clustered Column chart showing monthly headcount to visualize staffing trends.

STEP-BY-STEP INSTRUCTIONS

1. Select the range A2:B14 (Month and Headcount columns including headers).
2. Insert tab → Charts → Insert Column or Bar Chart.
3. Choose Clustered Column from the 2-D Column options.

WHAT THE RESULT LOOKS LIKE



A column chart appears in the spreadsheet. The Chart Design and Format tabs appear on the ribbon.

2 Create a Chart Sheet

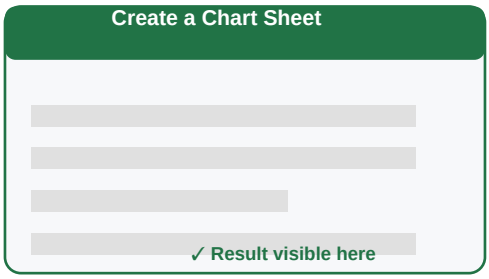
Chart De

Your Task: Move the headcount chart to its own dedicated sheet named "Headcount Chart".

STEP-BY-STEP INSTRUCTIONS

1. Click the chart to select it.
2. Chart Design tab → Location group → Move Chart.
3. Choose New sheet.
4. Type the name: Headcount Chart → OK.

WHAT THE RESULT LOOKS LIKE



The chart moves to its own full-page sheet tab. The HR Dashboard worksheet is unchanged.

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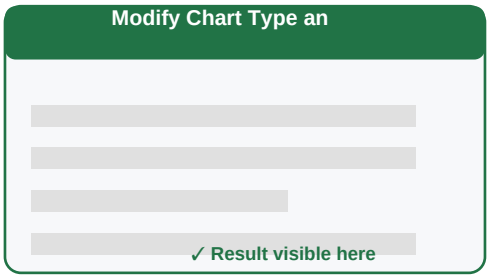
3 Modify Chart Type and Data

Your Task: Change the Column chart to a Line with Markers chart to better show the trend over time.

STEP-BY-STEP INSTRUCTIONS

1. Click the chart to select it.
2. Chart Design tab → Type group → Change Chart Type.
3. Choose Line from the left panel.
4. Select Line with Markers → OK.

WHAT THE RESULT LOOKS LIKE



The chart changes from columns to a line graph. The trend direction is clearer on a line chart.

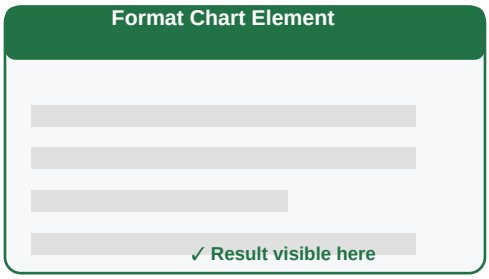
4 Format Chart Elements

Your Task: Apply a blue gradient fill to the data series to match the company color scheme.

STEP-BY-STEP INSTRUCTIONS

1. Double-click a data point or bar in the chart to open the Format Data Series pane.
2. In the Format pane → Fill & Line → Fill → Gradient fill.
3. Set gradient colors to shades of blue.
4. Close the Format pane.

WHAT THE RESULT LOOKS LIKE



The data series displays a blue gradient fill. The Format Data Series pane shows the applied settings.

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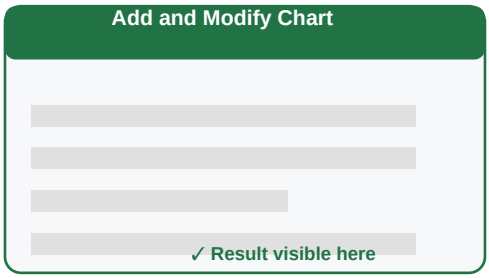
5 Add and Modify Chart Elements

Your Task: Add data labels above each point, add a linear trendline, and move the legend to the bottom.

STEP-BY-STEP INSTRUCTIONS

1. Click the chart.
2. Chart Design → Add Chart Element → Data Labels → Above.
3. Add Chart Element → Trendline → Linear.
4. Add Chart Element → Legend → Bottom.
5. Or click the + icon next to the chart for quick access.

WHAT THE RESULT LOOKS LIKE



Data labels show exact values above each point. A trendline runs through the data. The legend is at the bottom.

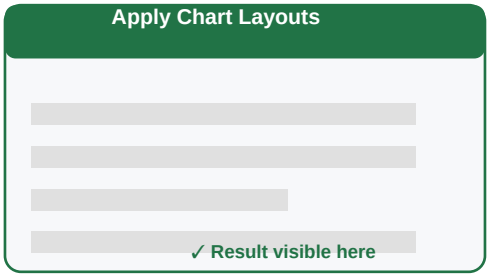
6 Apply Chart Layouts and Styles

Your Task: Apply Quick Layout 3 and Chart Style 8 for a polished professional appearance.

STEP-BY-STEP INSTRUCTIONS

1. Click the chart to select it.
2. Chart Design → Chart Layouts → Quick Layout → choose Layout 3.
3. Chart Design → Chart Styles → choose Style 8.

WHAT THE RESULT LOOKS LIKE



The chart has a professional layout and color scheme. Both the layout and style update immediately.

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7 Add Alt Text to Chart

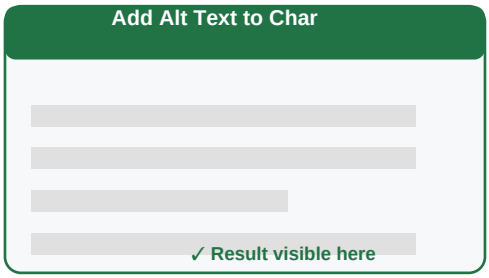
Right-clic

Your Task: Add descriptive alt text to the headcount chart for screen reader accessibility.

STEP-BY-STEP INSTRUCTIONS

1. Right-click the outer border of the chart (not inside it).
2. Choose Edit Alt Text from the context menu.
3. Type a description: Monthly headcount trend showing growth from 142 to 171 employees, January through December 2026.
4. Close the Alt Text pane.

WHAT THE RESULT LOOKS LIKE



The alt text is saved with the chart. Screen readers will describe the chart to visually impaired users.

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